

Striking Clothing Workers Claim Police Harassment

An estimated 300 striking garment workers led by Amalgamated Clothing Workers Business Agent Tony Sanchez and International Representative Felix de la Torre, met with City Council Thursday to protest police "harassment" and "intimidation."

The meeting with Council followed three days of strike violence at the Levi Strauss and Co. garment plant at 32100 Cypress and police arrest of a number of pickets.

Sanchez said two pickets were arrested for obstructing the plant entrance in an attempt to bar non-striking employees from entering and leaving. Sanchez said

they were picketing according to law and that it also is a violation of law for police to tell the pickets to move away from the entrance.

He also charged police with harassment of pickets on private property with permission of the owners.

De la Torre termed arrest of lawful pickets as direct intimidation.

MEET WITH CHIEF

The union leaders were instructed to meet with Police Chief Robert Minnie and Alderman Hector Bencomo Thursday afternoon after Mayor Pro Tem Sal Berroteran told the gathering that Council would not tolerate abuse on either side.

Council also heard complaints from Mrs. Kathryn Blackson and Andy Cohen of a private dump at Will Ruth and Threadgill. The dump used by contractors for disposing of waste building material has been a legal non-conforming use since the Northeast area was annexed into the City.

They claimed the area has been excavated to 100 feet and is being refilled with trash that blows throughout the neighborhood as well as creating a safety hazard.

HAVE INJUNCTION

Asst. City Atty. Rade Adkins said the City has obtained a court injunction to halt excavation of fill dirt adjacent to the street that has posed a threat of cave in and that excavation has halted at that area.

In other action, Council:

Approved first reading of zoning changes at 731 Hemphill, 9132 Roseway, 4013 N. Mesa and 10397 Dyer, and approved subdivision maps of Sunrise Acres Unit 2 and Cielo Vista Unit D.D.

Deeded eight lots northwest of Schuster and Hawthorne to the University of Texas at El Paso for \$6,000. The land is mostly located in an arroyo and was taken for taxes.

GRANT FRANCHISE

Granted franchise to Hotel Dieu to construct a pedestrian tunnel under Arizona to connect with the Stanton Medical Center.

Approved a Public Service Board Lease of a Quonset hut at 8930 Roseway to Harry Whipple for three years.

Authorized advertising of bids for street materials, fuel, oil, tires and batteries at an estimated \$320,000 cost.

Granted various travel requests, including travel of Asst. Traffic Director James Nolan and Concentrated Law Enforcement Director H. T. Vogel to a seminar July 28 on uniform safety standards in Austin; Comptroller Joseph Higdon to Estes Park, Colo., Aug. 23 for a five-day seminar on federal grant negotiation and administration; and park officials and contestants to Lubbock, Tex., Sunday for a regional hula hoop and frisbee contest.

Paid bills, including \$348,100 to R. E. McKee General Contractor, Inc., for construction of the Civic Center that is now 27 per cent complete.

Sons Of Sun Membership Drive Begins

The Sun Carnival's annual Sons of the Sun membership drive gets underway this week with an emphasis on broadening the membership base.

"El Paso's civic and service clubs have always been the predominant Sons of the Sun supporters, but we want to get all El Paso behind the Sun Carnival through membership in SOS this year," said Jack Kitchen, president of the Sun Carnival.

The annual drive began with a mailing of brochures and membership applications to members of the organization from last year.

A highlight of the brochure is a series of endorsements of the Sun Bowl from Bob Devaney, head coach and athletic director at Nebraska; Bud Carson, head coach at Georgia Tech; Vince Dooley, head coach at Georgia; Jim Carlen, head coach at Texas Tech; Tonto Coleman, commissioner of the Southeastern Conference, and Bill McPhail, vice president for sports at CBS-TV.

Kitchen described Sons of the Sun as the cornerstone of the entire Sun Carnival celebration.

STRESSED BENEFITS

Wayne Nisbett, vice-president of the Sun Carnival in charge of membership stressed the benefits to members of SOS, particularly the priority selection of tickets to the annual Sun Bowl game which will be held this year on Dec. 18.

SOS membership also allows unlimited ticket priorities to the Sun Queen's coronation and ball, reserved parking at both the Sun Bowl and the coronation, and special \$2 reserved tickets to the Sun Bowl for children up to 18 years old.

"For the past five years, near sell-outs at the Sun Bowl game have been recorded," Nisbett said, "and this trend is certain to continue."